

Q What are IBM's offerings for developers?

From a developer engagement perspective, we have refreshed our approach. Last year, we released several open source based reusable 'code patterns' and many 'How-to' and 'Do it yourself' articles as well, to help developers in their day-to-day work. Our developer advocacy engagement is based on three aspects – code, content and community. For developers, their key differentiator or what makes them successful in their profession is the code they write. Today, with the advent of open source technology and the availability of cloud platforms and tools, they're not restricted in their choices of programming languages, operating systems or infrastructure platforms. But what they can really do is to look at common use cases or common patterns.

The IBM Coder platform helps coders learn as well as test their knowledge, and then showcase that on the public platform.

Q How have these offerings evolved over the past few years?

If you remember, in the early days, we used object-oriented programming, UML and design patterns to create reusable patterns that helped kick-start a new project. Now, in the cloud and cognitive era, it's time for a new set of patterns to forge their way. These are code patterns built around cloud native computing, containers, microservices, artificial intelligence (AI) and the blockchain. The code patterns by IBM are available for developers as open source code, to extend, replicate and customise for their requirements. They also have a very detailed blueprint of the pattern itself, in terms of the core components such as underlying technologies, interaction diagrams and step-by-step instructions on how to build that basic pattern. We have over

100 patterns today in our catalogue and that number will keep growing across the various areas of technology.

Q How is your company working around content and community?

Around content, we have largely provided suitable sets of 'How-to' tutorials, videos and experts' views to extend support and motivate developers towards enriched contribution to the coding community.

The third aspect, after code and content, is community. Developers are willing to work with like-minded people and they're engaged in various external and internal communities,

within which there's a lot of knowledge sharing and ideation. There's also a lot of innovation happening around such communities. We are creating communities in which developers can interact and do better. We have also launched an online community known as 'IBM Coder', where coders not just participate in discussion forums but also take up a series of challenges. For coders, it is important to continuously update their skills and get recognised and awarded for these at the same time. The IBM Coder platform helps them learn as well as test their knowledge, and then showcase that on the public platform. They build up a certain profile and there are points attached to distinctive work as well.

Q Can you tell us more about IBM's role in the cloud space?

Our Cloud Object Storage (COS) solution addresses the weaknesses of the traditional storage options available today. Our cloud offering has a strong underlying Infrastructure as a Service offering and a strong cloud platform. Bringing together infrastructure and

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